Creative Portfolio Master Content

Tobi Afolayan | Content package for the creative portfolio | October 2026

This document brings together five pieces in my body of work across music, technology, research, and cultural experiences: a listener one-pager, expanded listening observations, two published essays, and an independent Llona strategy study. The essays are included in full and the strategy deck is reproduced page by page. The portfolio is organized around the work and the questions behind it. Company names provide context for particular pieces and do not imply a partnership, commission, endorsement, or access to private records.

Suggested portfolio introduction

A collection of work exploring how technology, music, and creative experiences connect people. These pieces bring together the questions I'm asking and the ways I'm learning, researching, and building around them.

Suggested selected work introduction

I'm interested in what makes music experiences meaningful and the systems that support the people behind them. My work brings together my perspective as a listener, software engineer, event producer, and graduate student studying music business and technology. Here I explore listening and fan experiences, remote performance, creator compensation, and independent artist strategy.

Editorial note: Both essays are published and are reproduced below in full from the drafts the author confirmed were published without edits. Keep their wording and references intact. Publication URLs were not supplied; do not invent them. Page names and summaries in this brief are proposed.

Suggested site structure

Home introduces Tobi and the creative identity, then leads to Selected Work. Selected Work is an editorial index, with concise descriptions and direct, shareable links to each piece. Organize the work by the ideas it explores rather than by company or application. Preserve the existing dark editorial design, grid, typography, and numbered sections while making long-form text easy to read.

Listening and Fan Experience

Independent Amazon Music one-pager and expanded observations. Present the two as distinct, related pieces; identify Amazon Music as the subject of the observations and retain their dates and qualifications.

Presence Beyond the Room

The complete published essay What does it mean to be at a concert, with its references and a comfortable reading experience.

The Systems Behind the Music

The complete published essay What happens after a song reaches us, with its references and a comfortable reading experience.

Llona Artist Enterprise Study

The complete 21-slide independent educational study. Preserve slide order; distinguish hypotheses and proposed strategies from verified facts. Automatic transcriptions may contain errors.

Architecting Culture

The existing Google Creative Fellowship experience, preserved with its content, media, links, section order, and visual identity. Explain the fellowship as the context in which this work was created.

These labels are working titles. Keep navigation responsive and accessible. Each piece should have a clear title, a short description, and an understandable format, with a way back to Selected Work.

Asset 1 Amazon Music listener one pager

Amazon Music listening and fan experience

Tobi Afolayan | Listener observations and proposed experiences | October 27 2026

I use Spotify for everyday listening and discovery, and Apple Music for parts of my existing library and album exploration. While using Amazon Music more intentionally, I kept asking what would make it my first choice. My strongest interest is how an easier listening experience could support a more personal, lasting connection with music and artists.

Make everyday listening easier

These observations come from my own listening notes from August 2026 and need checking against the current app version and subscription tier.

Return to saved music. When I open the app to hear something I saved, I want a clear, immediate route back to it.

Move between a track and its album. I found View Album inside More Options. I wanted an obvious route from the playing track to its full project.

Find the people behind the music. I eventually found credits through X-Ray, which I appreciated. Finding lyrics and credits felt less obvious than I expected.

Two experiences I would like to explore

Save what a song means to me. Listening to Llona has brought up questions about identity and change in my own life. I would like an optional, private way to attach a short reflection to a track, perhaps with a chosen timestamp, then revisit it later. My note would provide the meaning; listening history alone should not infer how I felt.

Carry a live moment into everyday listening. Imagine discovering a song during a livestream and saving that moment with a clear route to the studio track, artist page and replay where available. After the show, I could return to what caught my attention. This is a proposed journey to test, rather than a claim that each component is currently missing.

Start with a small test

First, observe listeners finding a saved album, opening the album behind a playing track, and locating credits. Track completion, time and wrong turns. Then test a simple prototype for saving and revisiting a personal note or performance moment. Does it feel useful enough to return to voluntarily? Can people find what they saved? Does the extra step interrupt listening?

My hypothesis is that preserving something personally meaningful could give listeners another reason to return. That needs testing. I bring a listener’s perspective alongside software engineering and event production experience, and would welcome feedback on which of these questions is most useful to investigate.

Asset 2 Amazon Music observations

Expanded and polished from my listening notes, August 2026. These are individual observations, questions, and ideas rather than a product audit or a representative user study. App versions, subscription tiers, and experiences can differ; verify the present experience before making current product claims.

Where I start

I use different services for different reasons. Apple Music holds much of my older library and is where I often turn to explore an artist's catalog or share music with friends. Spotify is where I listen day to day, find music, and exchange songs with people I connect with through music. Those experiences shape the question I bring to Amazon Music: what would make me choose it, return to it, and feel at home there?

Return to my music

When I open the app, I often want the music I have already saved. I want that route to be immediate, welcoming, and personal. Discovery can build on that foundation, but I should not have to search for my own library every time.

Make the connections easier to find

While listening, I wanted a clear way to move from a track to the album and artist, discover featured artists, and share an artist profile. In my notes, View Album was inside More Options. I later discovered that tapping the artist name on a track opened the artist profile. The functionality I missed initially may have existed; my difficulty finding it is part of the observation.

Show the people behind the music

I looked for lyrics, credits, descriptions, and context around artists and projects. I eventually found X-Ray and appreciated being able to see credits there. I would like those paths to be easier to notice, especially when I'm already listening. An incomplete profile does not tell me why information is missing.

Listen and share without breaking the flow

I noted that I could not readily find a way to queue an album while another track played. I would test this again before treating it as a current product limitation. I also want artist-profile sharing to feel straightforward, with a clear action close to where I discover the artist.

Offer choice in interaction

Voice control is not my preferred way to navigate, partly because of my experience with my accent. A useful experience should give people reliable, easy-to-find alternatives to voice commands.

What worked for me

X-Ray became more interesting once I found the credits. I also found content recommendations promising, and appreciated a notification about a Rema concert in New York. Those are personal reactions, not proof of how well the same features work for everyone.

A listening history with personal context

Some songs take me back to a person, a place, an outfit, or a season of my life. I want a simple, optional way to capture why a song matters in the moment and revisit that context later without leaving my listening experience. Any personal note should be controlled by the listener. AI assistance is a question to explore, not a prerequisite or a substitute for the listener's own meaning.

Music beyond playback

I’m interested in how discovery, live events, campus experiences, artist activations, and releases could deepen the relationship between artists and fans. A useful starting point is a continuous journey: find a performance, experience it, save a meaningful moment, and return to the music afterward.

Questions about Nigeria

I also want to examine how digital access and local partnerships shape music experiences in Nigeria, and how creators and communities participate in the value generated there. This is a research direction, not a claim that a particular solution has been validated.

Asset 3 Immersive audio published essay

The following article was published in the form of the prior draft, as confirmed by the author. Preserve its complete wording and references. Publication URL not supplied.

What does it mean to be at a concert

Watching Asake on YouTube and thinking about the people outside the room

I watched Asake's Red Bull Symphonic performance on YouTube. I wasn't at Kings Theatre. The performance happened in Brooklyn on November 8, 2025, and the full recording arrived on his official channel in December. [1–2]

That distinction matters to the question I've been sitting with. I had access to the performance, but what kind of access was it? What does it mean to experience a concert after it has happened, through a screen, somewhere else?

Asake performed with conductor Glenn Alexander II and an orchestra, bringing his music into a different arrangement and setting. [1] For me, that makes this a useful place to begin. The recording lets someone encounter a version of the music that belongs to a particular performance. It also raises questions about everything around that music: the room, the audience, and the relationship between the people onstage and the people listening.

I keep wondering what we should want for the fan who cannot be there.

Who gets to be in the room

Someone can care deeply about an artist and still miss the show. They may live in another country. The ticket may be beyond their budget. Work, family, transport, or access needs may make attendance difficult. Their relationship with the music still exists.

I'm Nigerian, studying music business and music technology, and working as a software engineer. I also produce events. Those experiences keep bringing me back to the same problem from different directions: what are we actually trying to make possible for the person using what we build?

With remote concerts, making the performance available is already valuable. I could watch this one because a recording existed and someone made it accessible. But availability leaves room for another question. How do we help a remote listener feel involved in the performance they chose to watch?

I don't have a finished answer. I think it deserves more attention than simply adding another feature to a video player.

What exactly are we trying to preserve

Producing events makes me think about what happens around a performance. People arrive with expectations. They react to one another. A familiar song can mean something different when other people are responding to it nearby. From that perspective, the audience is part of what I want to understand.

My graduate research started with a narrower question: how could headphone listening preserve the impression of performers occupying a shared acoustic space?

Two terms helped me become more precise. Externalization describes hearing a sound as coming from outside your head. Envelopment describes the sensation of being surrounded by sound. They concern different aspects of listening. Neither, by itself, establishes that someone feels they attended a concert. [3]

That distinction changed the way I thought about the problem. Clearer sound, a more convincing acoustic space, and a stronger connection to other listeners might each improve an experience. They need to be investigated separately before we assume they add up to the same thing.

When I ask whether a remote fan can feel closer to a performance, I need to say what "closer" means.

What the research can tell us

One study I reviewed examined speech reproduced over headphones as virtual sound sources. Coupling large head movements with head tracking improved externalization, including for listeners without previous binaural listening experience. [4] Put simply, allowing the sound scene to respond to the listener's movement helped the voice feel more external.

That gives me a reason to investigate how movement and spatial sound might work together. It does not establish that the same setup makes a concert more enjoyable, or makes someone feel connected to a crowd. The study used speech under controlled conditions. A concert introduces different material and different expectations.

I also cannot diagnose the capture or mixing choices behind Asake's recording from my experience watching it. I'm using it as the starting point for a question, rather than as evidence that a particular production technique failed.

The useful next step, to me, would be a comparison. Let people hear the same performance through different presentations, then ask distinct questions. Where do they perceive the performers? Do they feel surrounded by the sound? Do they enjoy it more? Does it help them stay involved?

If a more complicated system produces no meaningful benefit for the listener, that is something I want to know early.

What would I build for the person watching

I'd begin with someone who already wants to watch the artist. They should be able to find the performance, understand how to listen, and settle into it without unnecessary effort. Any added technology has to earn its place in that experience.

Then I would explore the social part. Could two friends in different cities choose to watch together and stay in sync? Would they want to hear each other's reactions, or would that interrupt the music? Some people may want company; others may prefer to listen alone. I'd want to learn what people actually choose before deciding that more interaction is better.

Watching a recording later also offers something different from joining a performance as it happens. I can return to a passage, pause, or listen again. For a real-time experience, the question might be what makes joining at that particular time worthwhile. For a replay, it might be what makes the performance worth returning to.

There's something personal here too. If a moment in a performance stays with me, could I save it with a short note about why? I'm interested in giving listeners a way to preserve an association they choose to express. A listening history cannot tell the whole story of what a song meant to someone.

Where I want to take this

The research direction I'm working toward begins with sound, but it keeps leading me back to people. I want to understand which parts of a live experience remote listeners value, which can be translated, and which require a different approach altogether.

Asake's performance gives me a concrete example to keep returning to. The concert happened in one room, on one night. I encountered it later through YouTube. What I want to investigate is how much more thoughtfully we could design for the people whose relationship with that performance begins somewhere else.

Sources and further listening

[1] Red Bull. Red Bull Symphonic featuring Asake. Official event listing, November 8, 2025, Kings Theatre, Brooklyn. https://www.redbull.com/us-en/events/symphonic-nyc-asake

[2] ASAKE. Asake — Red Bull Symphonic Full Performance. Official artist channel, published December 11, 2025. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lIp-OwMozKI

[3] Best, V., et al. (2020). Sound Externalization A Review of Recent Research. Trends in Hearing. https://doi.org/10.1177/2331216520948390. The distinction between externalization and envelopment also draws on my September 2026 paper Preserving Auditory Presence in Remote Concert Listening, including Dick and Vigeant (2019), https://doi.org/10.1121/1.5096161.

[4] Hendrickx, E., et al. (2017). Improvement of Externalization by Listener and Source Movement Using a Binauralized Microphone Array. Journal of the Audio Engineering Society, 65(7/8), 589–599. https://doi.org/10.17743/jaes.2017.0018

Asset 4 Streaming published essay

The following article was published in the form of the prior draft, as confirmed by the author. Preserve its complete wording and references. Publication URL not supplied.

What happens after a song reaches us

On Nigerian music and the gap between being heard and benefiting from it

Tobi Afolayan

The outro of Llona's "What Do I Do?" has been staying with me. I hear questions about where we come from, who we are becoming, and whether people will still recognize us when our lives begin to look different. That is my reading of the song. It found me while I was asking some of those questions myself.

I can explain what the music gave me. I know much less about what my listening gives back to the people who made it.

That gap has become harder to ignore as I study music business. I work in software, where I am used to asking what has to happen behind an experience for it to work. A song starts playing almost immediately. The information and agreements behind that moment are much harder to follow.

When Nigerian music travels, I feel proud. I grew up in Ilorin. Hearing music from home reach people elsewhere means something to me. But I keep coming back to a question: what would tell us that the people making it are benefiting from that reach?

A listener count gives us part of the story. It cannot tell us what somebody owns, what their agreement allows them to keep, or whether a payment has reached them. Those questions require looking somewhere less visible than the charts.

While writing a paper on streaming, I found myself separating problems I had initially placed together. Getting music onto a service is one task. Helping people discover it is another. Collecting revenue and getting the correct share to the correct person involve further work. Progress in one part does not settle the others.

Consider two hypothetical creators. One receives an accurate payment under an agreement that leaves them with a small share. Another is entitled to a larger share, but information needed to identify their contribution is missing. Both might look at a statement and feel something is wrong. Their situations need different responses. Better data would help the second person; the first may need better terms.

Even the number of plays needs context. Spotify says its royalties are calculated through streamshare rather than a fixed payment for every play. Its market-level royalty pools depend on subscription and advertising revenue. What ultimately reaches an artist also depends on agreements with the organizations handling their music. A million plays cannot, by itself, tell us someone's take-home income. [1]

This matters when we talk about Nigeria. I want to understand what listening and paying actually look like there, rather than take an explanation built around the United States and change the artist's name.

There are already local arrangements worth examining. Audiomack offers an option to activate Audiomack+ using MTN Nigeria airtime. [2] That is a concrete example of a music service adapting how someone can pay. It raises questions I want to pursue: who uses that route, what makes it useful, and how much of the resulting revenue reaches creators? The existence of a payment option does not answer those questions, but it gives the research somewhere specific to begin.

Then there is the information that travels with the music. The person we recognize on the cover may be one of several contributors. For payments to reach the appropriate people, organizations need to know which work was used and who has a claim to it.

In the United States, the Mechanical Licensing Collective provides tools for registering musical works and matching recordings to those works so the digital audio mechanical royalties it administers can be paid. [3] That is one category of royalties in one jurisdiction. It does not establish the scale of any Nigerian problem. It does show that making music available and identifying who should receive a particular payment are separate jobs.

As an engineer, I am drawn to that work. I also have to resist assuming every difficulty needs an application. A database can hold information. Someone still needs authority to correct it, a reason to maintain it, and a process for resolving conflicting claims. Sometimes the next useful question concerns responsibility rather than technology.

I think about the creator trying to make sense of all of this while continuing to create. Would they know what a statement was telling them? Could they check a missing payment? Who could they ask, and would that person explain the answer in a way they could use?

These are the questions behind the infrastructure I want to understand. I am still learning which problems are most consequential, and whose experience I need to hear before deciding what to build.

Llona's music gave me a way to think about my own life. That does not give me access to his business arrangements, and I cannot infer his financial circumstances from how deeply a song moved me. It does make me care about the conditions that allow people to keep making work like this.

For Nigeria and the wider industry, success should mean more than exporting culture or increasing play counts. It should mean building the systems through which creators can participate in, understand, and benefit from the value their music generates.

I wrote that at the end of my paper. I am beginning to understand how much work is inside it.

Sources

1 Spotify How is streamshare calculated?; Understanding Spotify royalties
https://loudandclear.byspotify.com/faqs/how-is-streamshare-calculated/
https://support.spotify.com/lc/artists/article/understanding-spotify-royalties/

2 Audiomack Subscribe to Audiomack+ with MTN Nigeria
https://audiomack.com/plus/activate/mtn/ng

3 The Mechanical Licensing Collective Royalty Income Tracking
https://www.themlc.com/royalty-income-tracking

Asset 5 Llona independent artist strategy deck

This is an independent educational strategy study, not commissioned work. The 21 slide images below preserve the original deck. Text beneath each image is automatic transcription for search and accessibility; it may contain errors and is not a substitute for the slide. Verify factual claims against sources before converting them to public statements. Present proposals and inferences as such, not as the artist's actual plans, finances, or endorsement.

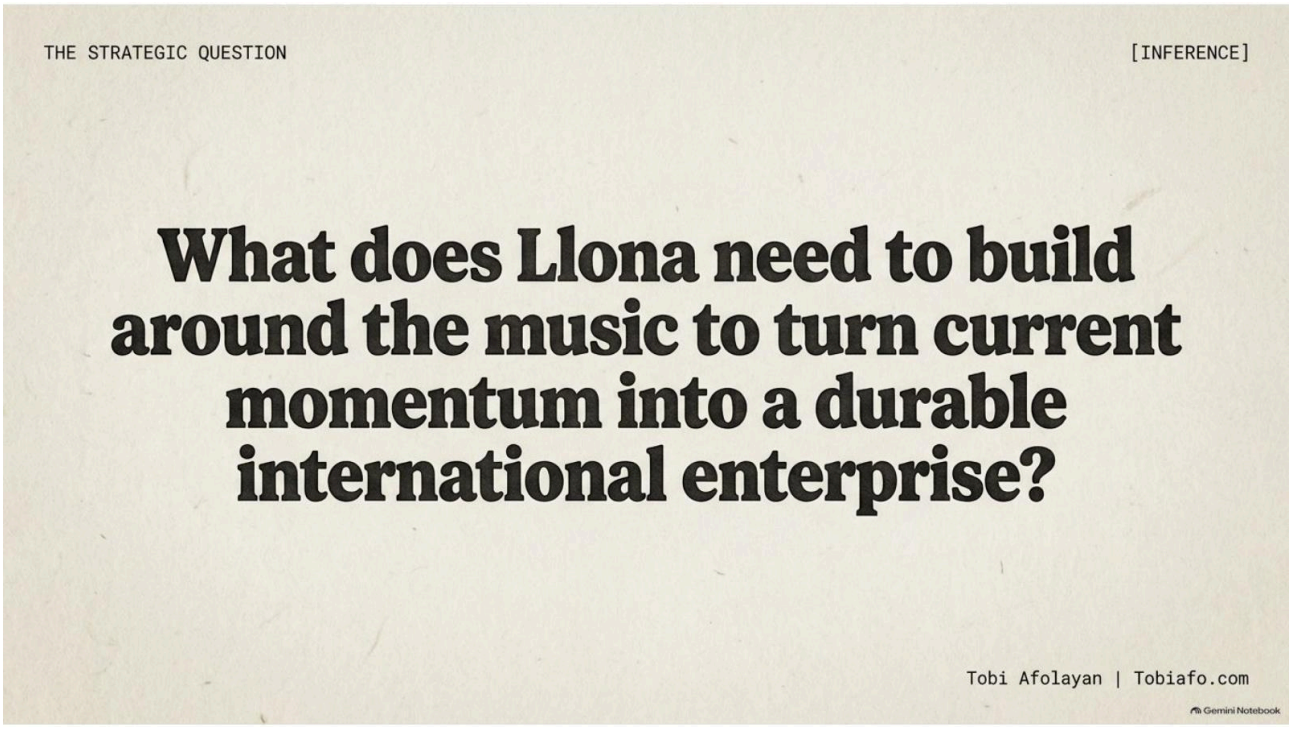
Llona strategy slide 1



Automatic transcription for reference

LLONA: WHAT'S WHATS NEXT? Artist Enterprise Strategy: | [inoePenpent stupy] Nigeria > UK > Global Independent educational study using public information and AI-assisted research/synthesis, not commissioned work; public infozmation may be incomplete Tobi Afolayan | Tobiafo.com

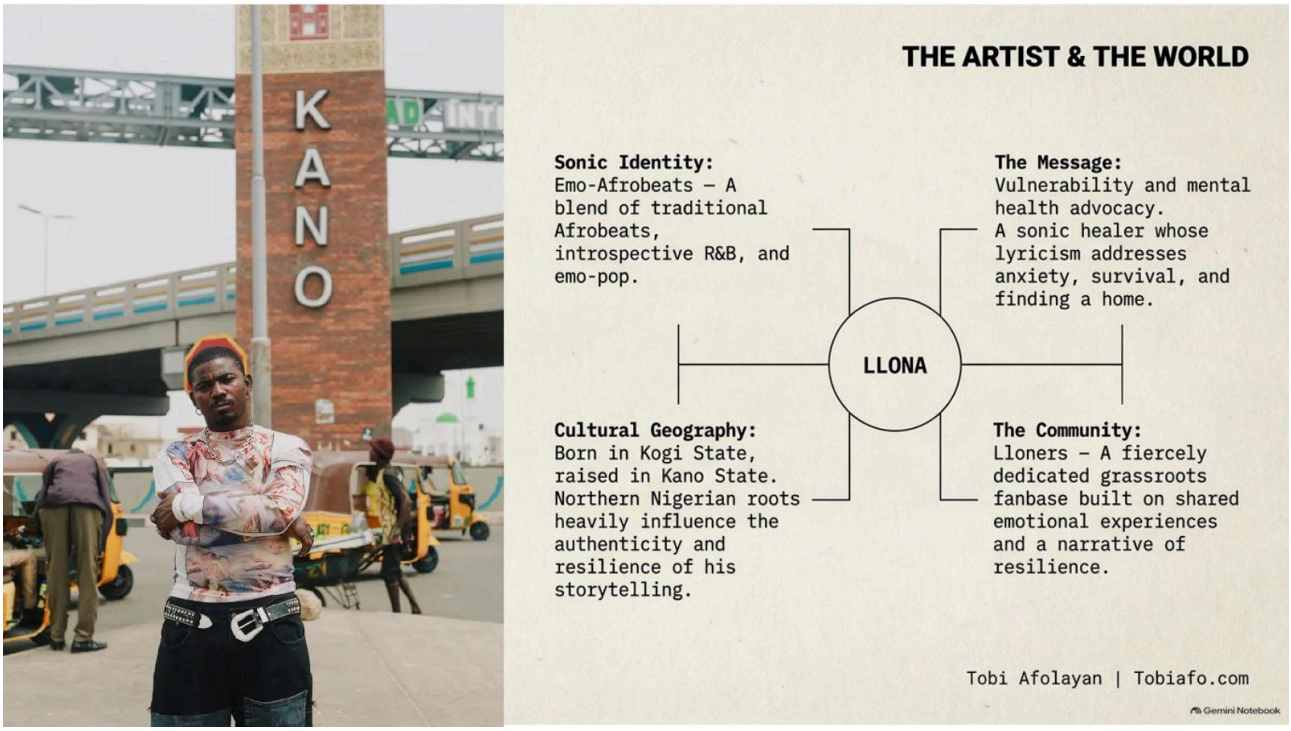
Llona strategy slide 2



Automatic transcription for reference

THE STRATEGIC QUESTION [INFERENCE] What does Llona need to build around the music to turn current momentum into a durable international enterprise? Tobi Afolayan | Tobiafo.com Gemini Note! ebook

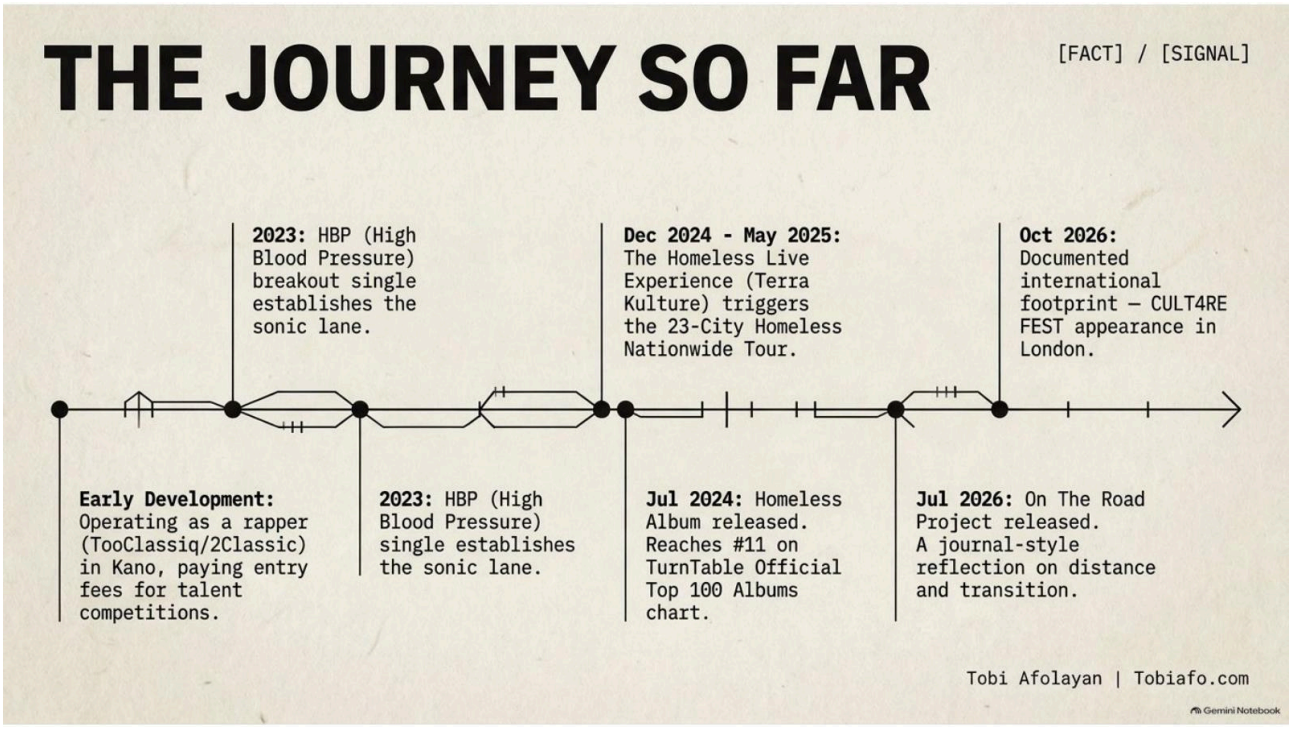
Llona strategy slide 3



Automatic transcription for reference

THE ARTIST & THE WORLD Sonic Identity: The Message: Emo-Afrobeats — A Vulnerability and mental blend of traditional health advocacy. Afrobeats, A sonic healer whose introspective R&B, and emo-pop. lyricism addresses anxiety, survival, and finding a home. Cultural Geography: Born in Kogi State, raised in Kano State. Northern Nigerian roots The Community: Lloners - A fiercely dedicated grassroots fanbase built on shared heavily influence the emotional experiences authenticity and and a narrative of resilience of his resilience. storytelling. Tobi Afolayan | Tobiafo.com AY Gemini Notebook

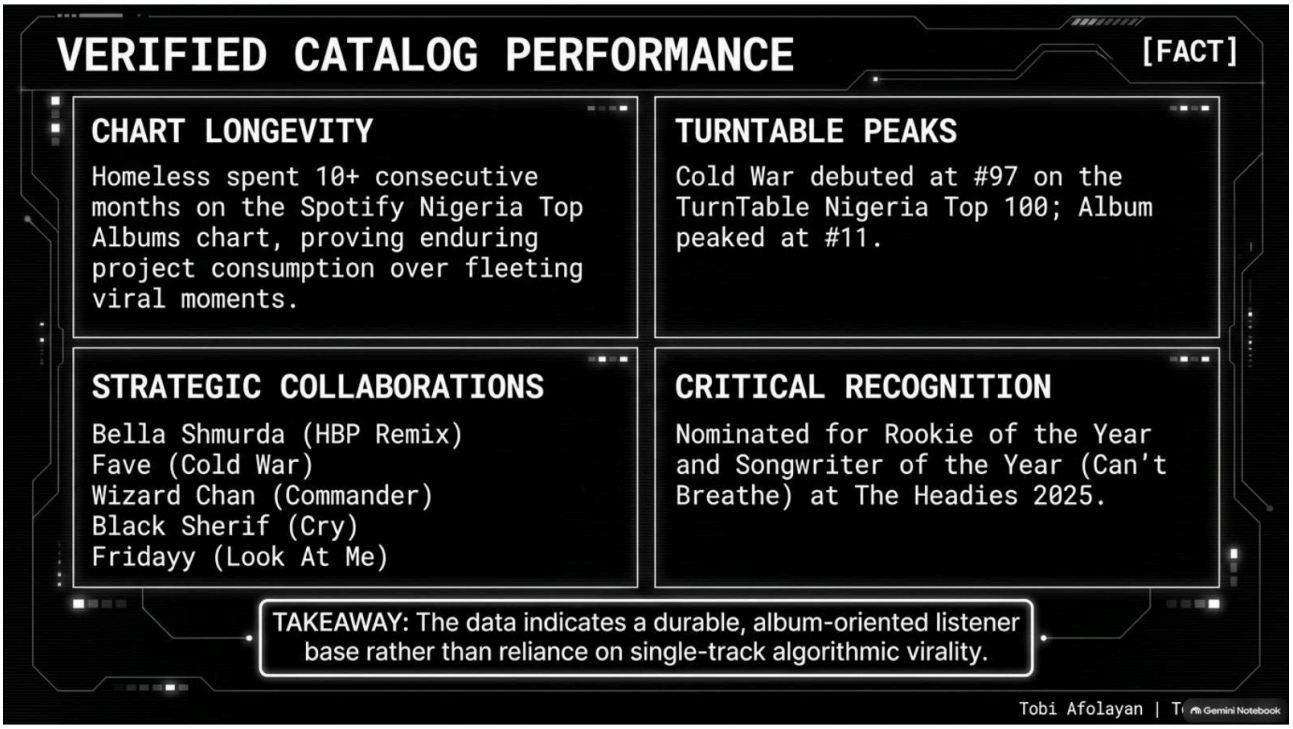
Llona strategy slide 4



Automatic transcription for reference

THE JOURNEY SO FAR “™ 2023: HBP (High Dec 2024 - May 2025: Oct 2026: Blood Pressure) The Homeless Live Documented breakout single Experience (Terra international establishes the Kulture) triggers footprint — CULT4RE sonic lane. the 23-City Homeless FEST appearance in Nationwide Tour. London. . — Early Development: 2023: HBP (High Jul 2024: Homeless Jul 2026: On The Road Operating as a rapper Blood Pressure) Album released. Project released. (TooClassiq/2Classic) single establishes Reaches #11 on A journal-style in Kano, paying entry the sonic lane. TurnTable Official reflection on distance fees for talent Top 100 Albums and transition. competitions. chart. Tobi Afolayan | Tobiafo.com AY Gemini Notebook

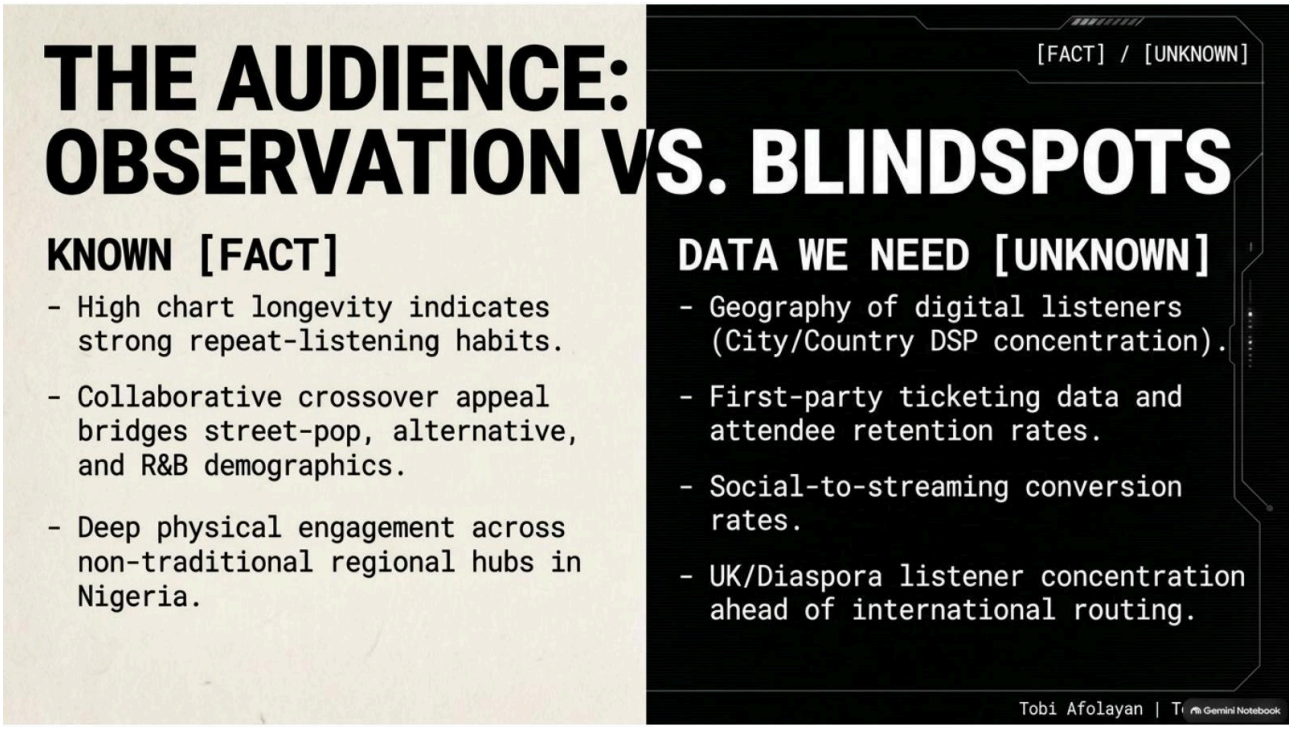
Llona strategy slide 5



Automatic transcription for reference

Tar VERIFIED CATALOG PERFORMANCE . [FACT] "| CHART LONGEVITY TURNTABLE PEAKS Homeless spent 10+ consecutive Cold War debuted at #97 on the months on the Spotify Nigeria Top TurnTable Nigeria Top 100; Album Albums chart, proving enduring peaked at #11. project consumption over fleeting viral moments. STRATEGIC COLLABORATIONS CRITICAL RECOGNITION Bella Shmurda (HBP Remix) Nominated for Rookie of the Year Fave (Cold War) and Songwriter of the Year (Can't Wizard Chan (Commander) Breathe) at The Headies 2025. Black Sherif (Cry) Fridayy (Look At Me) . TAKEAWAY: The data indicates a durable, album-oriented listener base rather than reliance on single-track algorithmic virality. Tobi Afolayan | Ti mcemininotebook

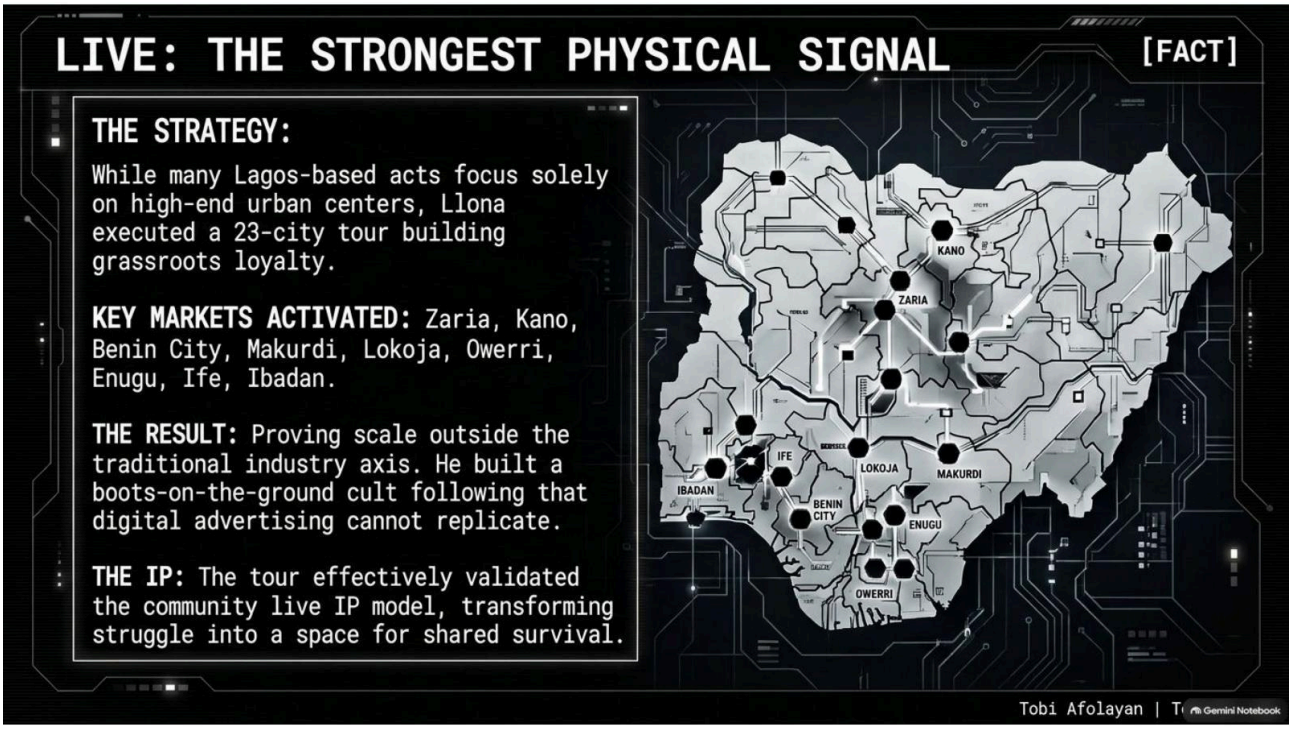
Llona strategy slide 6



Automatic transcription for reference

Tar THE AUDIENCE: eon ee OBSERVATION VME Seok KNOWN [FACT] DATA WE NEED [UNKNOWN] - High chart longevity indicates - Geography of digital listeners : strong repeat-listening habits. (City/Country DSP concentration). : Collaborative crossover appeal - First-party ticketing data and bridges street-pop, alternative, attendee retention rates. and R&B demographics. : , F - Social-to-streaming conversion Deep physical engagement across rates. non-traditional regional hubs in : : - UK/Diaspora listener concentration Nigeria. ahead of international routing. Tobi Afolayan | Ti mcemininotebook

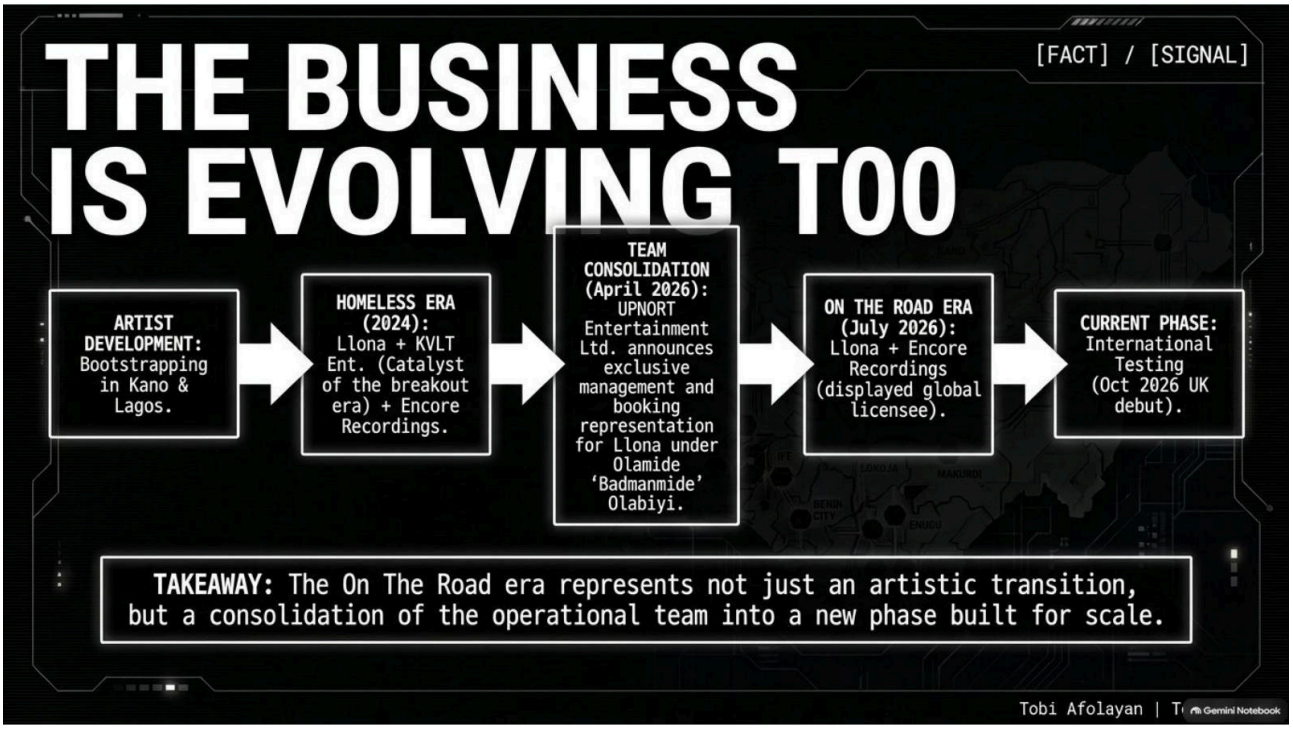
Llona strategy slide 7



Automatic transcription for reference

“LIVE: THE STRONGEST PHYSICAL SIGNAL » | THE STRATEGY: While many Lagos-based acts focus solely on high-end urban centers, Llona executed a 23-city tour building grassroots loyalty. KEY MARKETS ACTIVATED: Zaria, Kano, Benin City, Makurdi, Lokoja, Owerri, Enugu, Ife, Ibadan. THE RESULT: Proving scale outside the traditional industry axis. He built a boots-on-the-ground cult following that digital advertising cannot replicate. THE IP: The tour effectively validated the community live IP model, transforming struggle into a space for shared survival. vy, Ve ia Sg iE i= 1} (A 1‘ Tobi Afolayan | Ti mcemininotebook

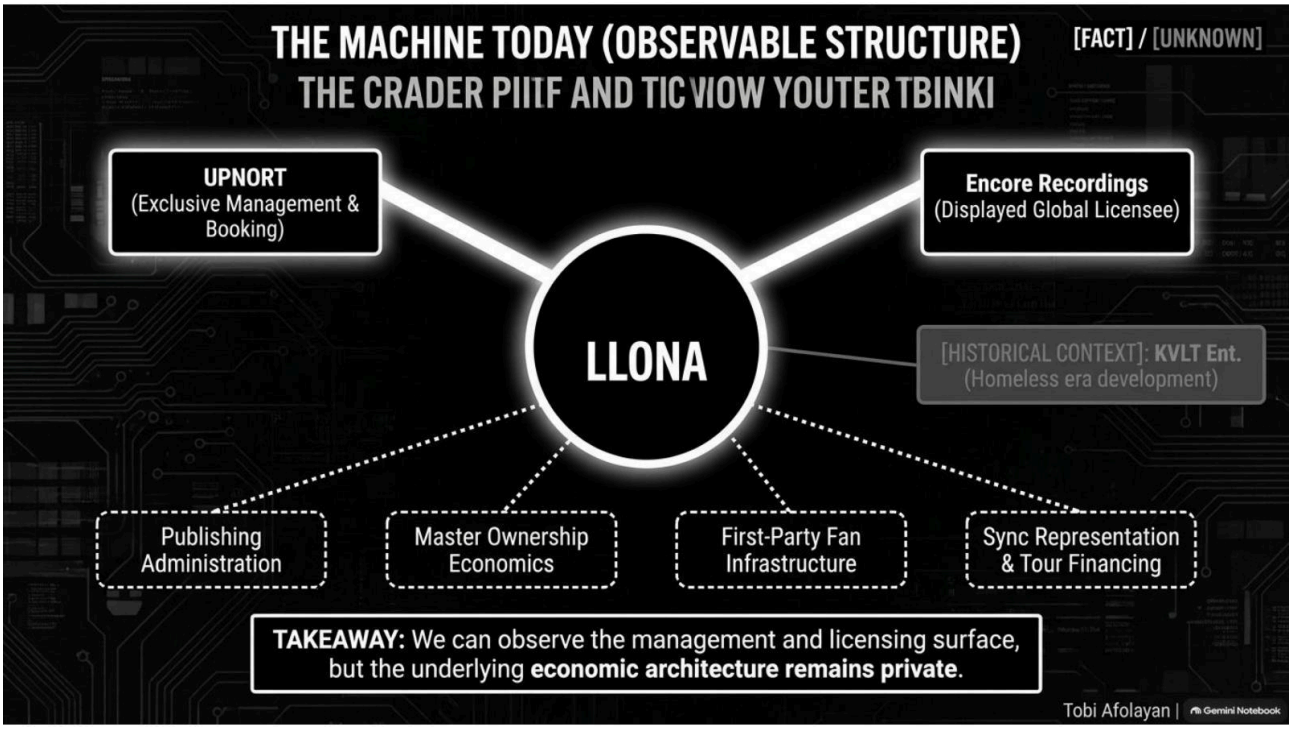
Llona strategy slide 8



Automatic transcription for reference

77 THE BUSINESS ia IS EVOLVING T00 cir ri : HOMELESS ERA PIIPNORT ON THE ROAD ERA ARTIST (2024): Entertainment (July 2026): CURRENT PHASE: DEVELOPMENT: Llona + KVLT Ltd. announces Llona + Encore International Bootstrapping Ent. (Catalyst exclusive Recordings Testing in Kano & of the breakout management and (displayed global (Oct 2026 UK Lagos. era) + Encore booking licensee) . debut). Recordings. representation for Llona under Olamide 'Badmanmide' Olabiyi. TAKEAWAY: The On The Road era represents not just an artistic transition, but a consolidation of the operational team into a new phase built for scale. Tobi Afolayan | Ti mcemininotebook

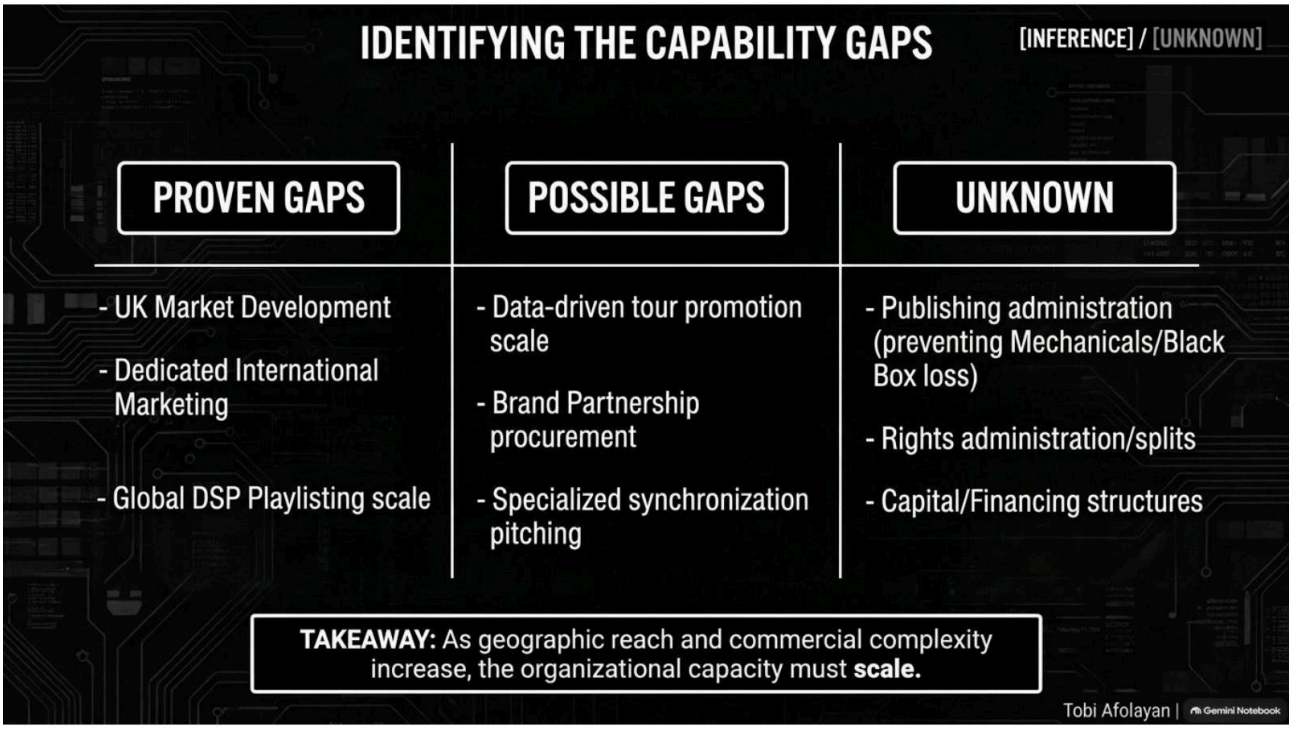
Llona strategy slide 9



Automatic transcription for reference

THE MACHINE TODAY (OBSERVABLE STRUCTURE) = [AcT/ (unknown THE CRADER PIITF AND TIC VIOW YOUTER TBINKI UPNORT (Exclusive Management & Booking) Encore Recordings (Displayed Global Licensee) [HISTORICAL CONTEXT]: KVLT Ent. (Homeless era development) eee eee oe ewww ent ae anew nennnn, H Publishing Master Ownership } First-PartyFan ! | Sync Representation : ' — Administration Economics H Infrastructure : &TourFinancing } Nene senapenbosnecneeseas = 9 | eeceeatceciweuseeeseuee' 'Sadcseewceesscecsccneea') to sneeeneceseereerenensss TAKEAWAY: We can observe the management and licensing surface, but the underlying economic architecture remains private. Tobi Afolayan | mceminino tebook

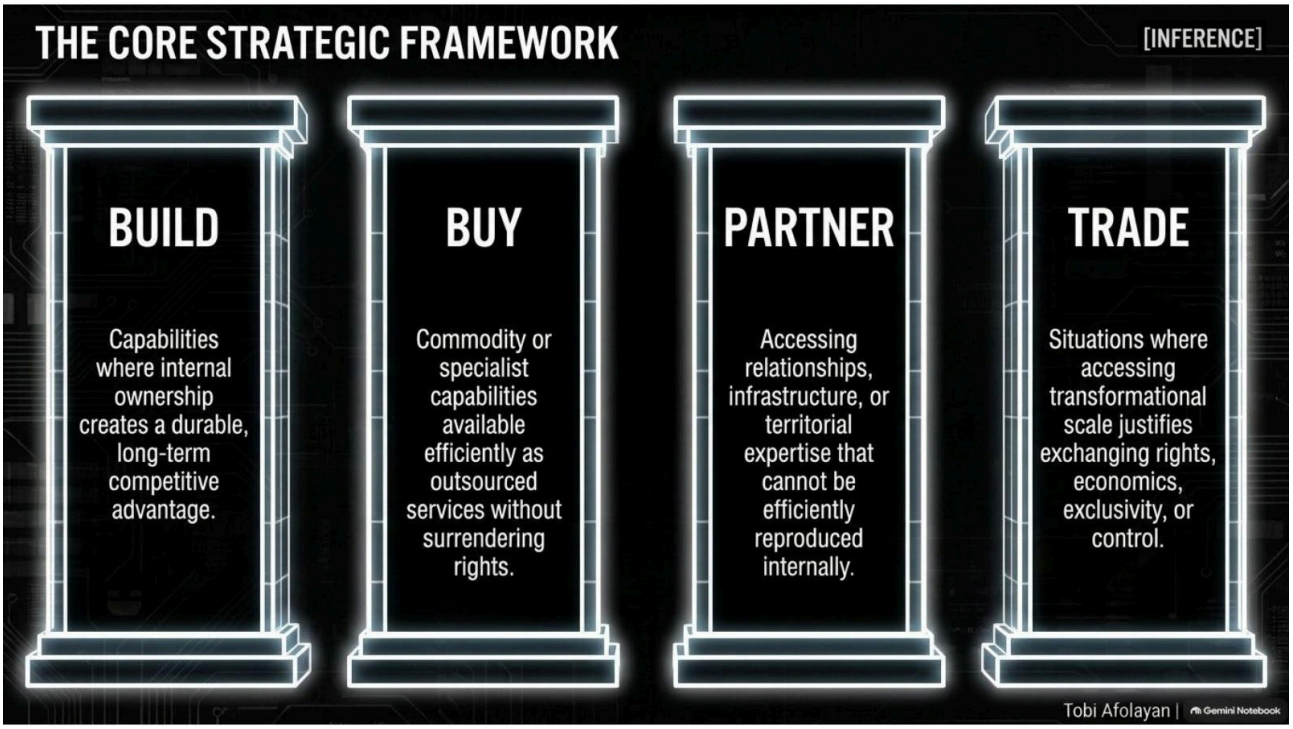
Llona strategy slide 10



Automatic transcription for reference

IDENTIFYING THE CAPABILITY GAPS Pee eee PROVEN GAPS POSSIBLE GAPS - UK Market Development - Data-driven tour promotion - Publishing administration scale (preventing Mechanicals/Black - Dedicated International Box loss) Marketing - Brand Partnership procurement - Rights administration/splits - Global DSP Playlisting scale | - Specialized synchronization - Capital/Financing structures pitching TAKEAWAY: As geographic reach and commercial complexity increase, the organizational capacity must scale. Tobi Afolayan | cemininotebook

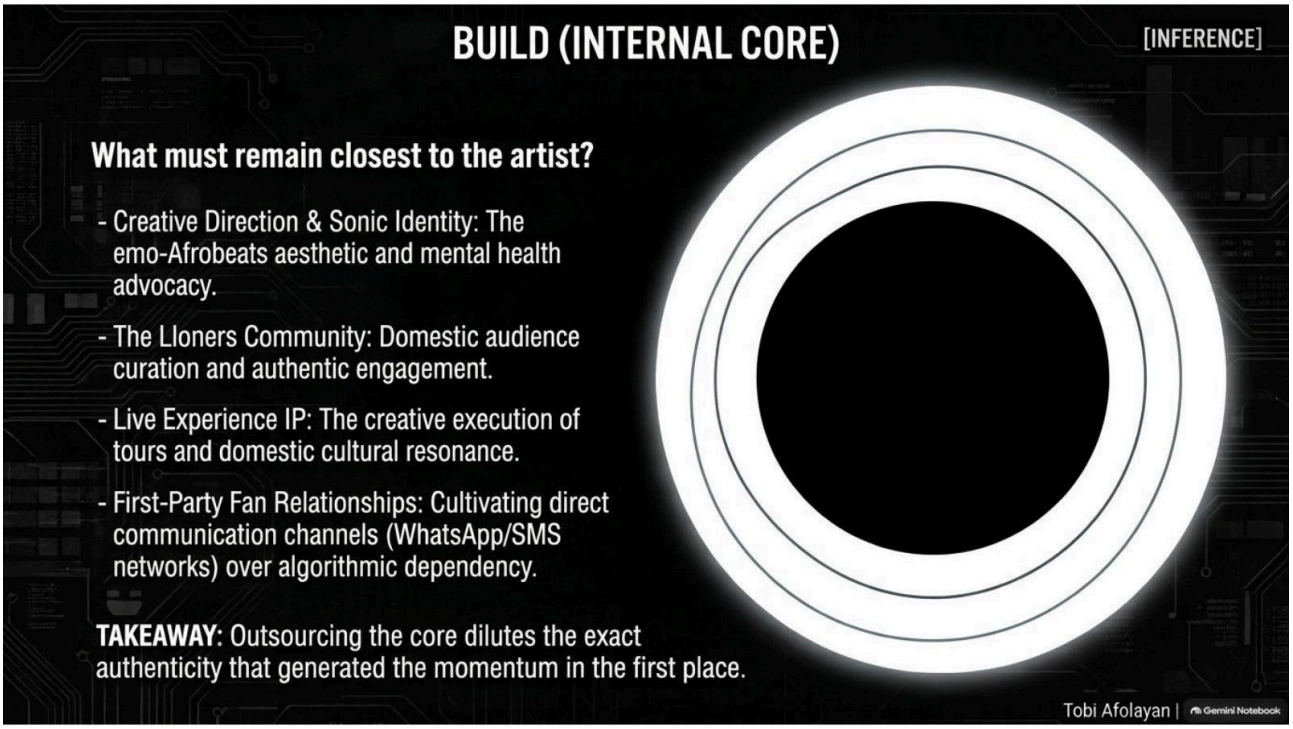
Llona strategy slide 11



Automatic transcription for reference

THE CORE STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK [INFERENCE] Capabilities Commodity or where internal specialist Accessing Situations where relationships, accessing infrastructure, or transformational territorial scale justifies expertise that exchanging rights, cannot be economics, efficiently exclusivity, or reproduced internally. ownership capabilities creates a durable, available long-term efficiently as competitive outsourced advantage. services without surrendering Tobi Afolayan | mcemininotebook

Llona strategy slide 12



Automatic transcription for reference

BUILD (INTERNAL CORE) [INFERENCE] What must remain closest to the artist? - Creative Direction & Sonic Identity: The emo-Afrobeats aesthetic and mental health advocacy. - The Lloners Community: Domestic audience curation and authentic engagement. - Live Experience IP: The creative execution of tours and domestic cultural resonance. - First-Party Fan Relationships: Cultivating direct communication channels (WhatsApp/SMS networks) over algorithmic dependency. TAKEAWAY: Outsourcing the core dilutes the exact authenticity that generated the momentum in the first place. Tobi Afolayan | mceminotebook

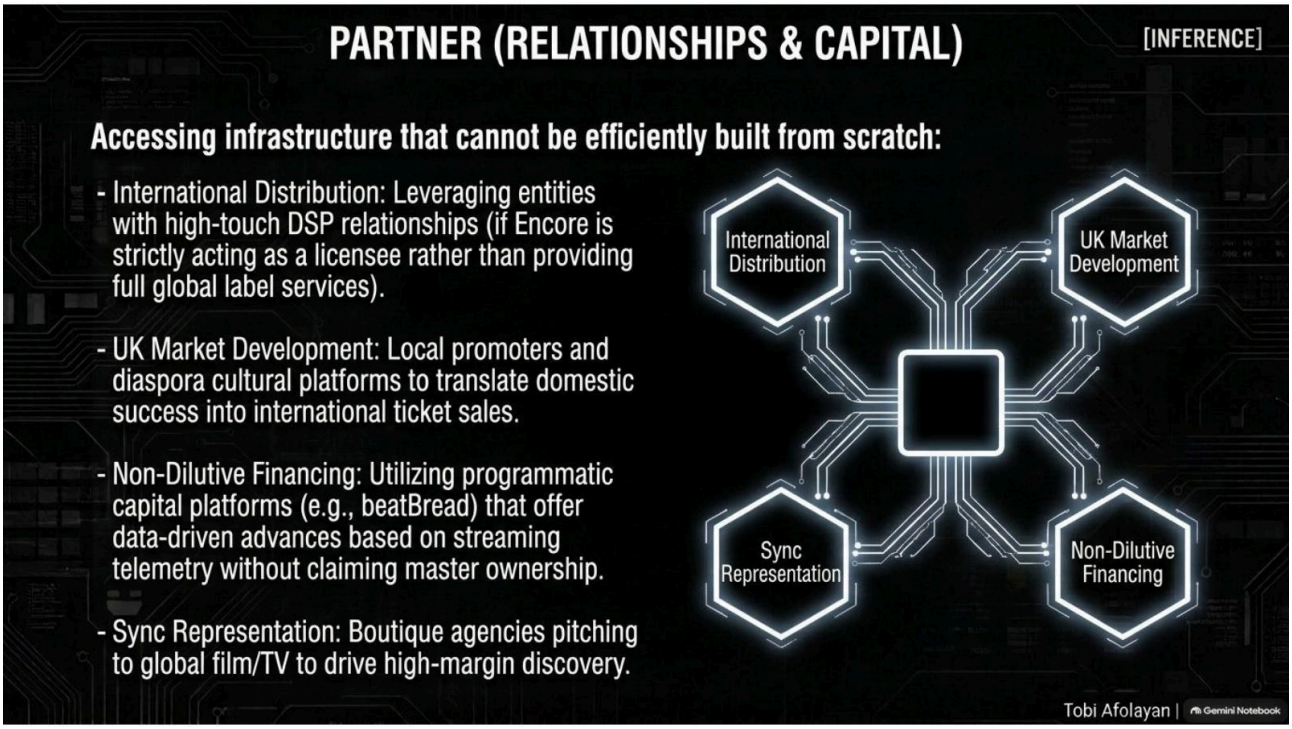
Llona strategy slide 13



Automatic transcription for reference

BUY (SPECIALIST INFRASTRUCTURE) [INFERENCE] Utilizing flat-fee or administrative commission services to scale without losing equity: Publishing Administration: Using services like CTRL Music (specifically built for African writers) or Songtrust to register works across global PROs/MROs and collect mechanicals/performance royalties, avoiding the black box. Neighboring Rights Collection: Ensuring digital performance royalties for the master recording are collected globally. Legal & Accounting: Establishing international tax compliance and rigorous royalty auditing. Territorial PR: Hiring regional publicists on retainer for specific diaspora market pushes. OUOU Tobi Afolayan | ™cemininotebook

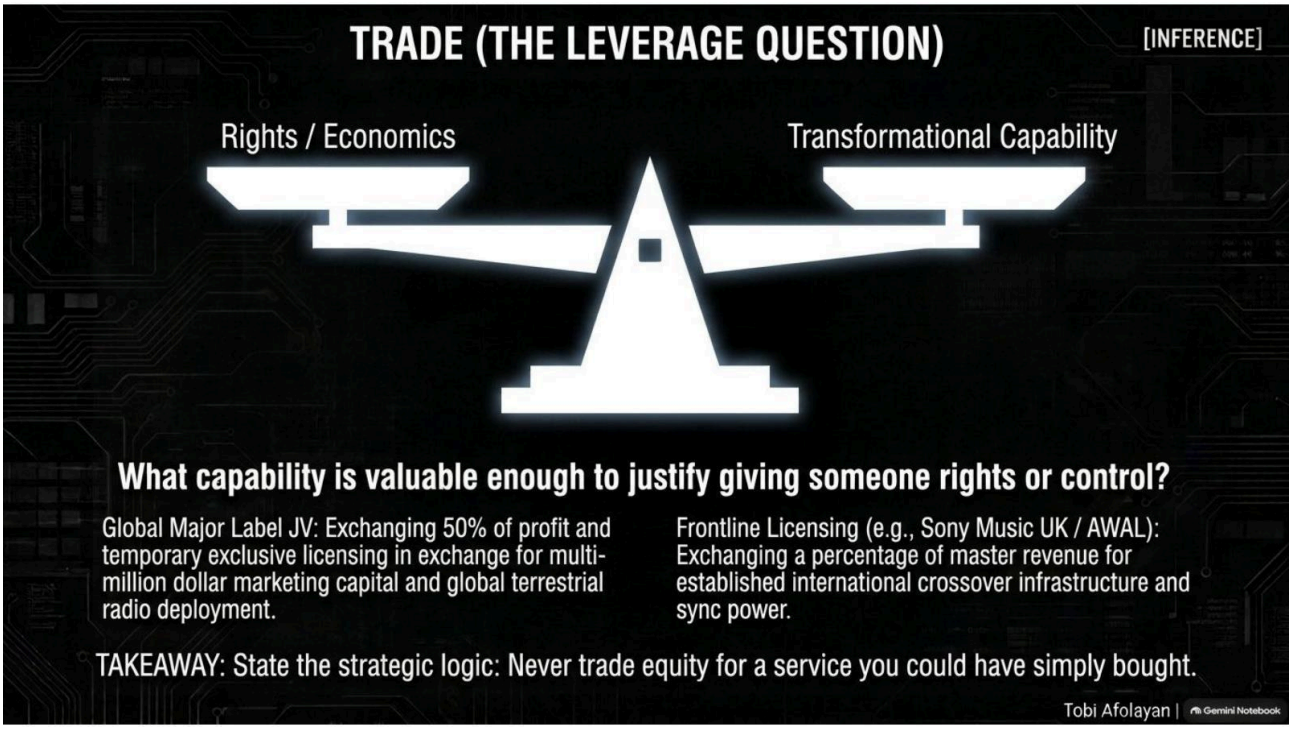
Llona strategy slide 14



Automatic transcription for reference

PARTNER (RELATIONSHIPS & CAPITAL) Accessing infrastructure that cannot be efficiently built from scratch: - International Distribution: Leveraging entities with high-touch DSP relationships (if Encore is strictly acting as a licensee rather than providing full global label services). - UK Market Development: Local promoters and diaspora cultural platforms to translate domestic success into international ticket sales. - Non-Dilutive Financing: Utilizing programmatic capital platforms (e.g., beatBread) that offer data-driven advances based on streaming telemetry without claiming master ownership. - Sync Representation: Boutique agencies pitching to global film/TV to drive high-margin discovery. International fe Distribution J" Representation} [INFERENCE] : Development QA =4 Non-Dilutive Financing Tobi Afolayan | mceminino tebook

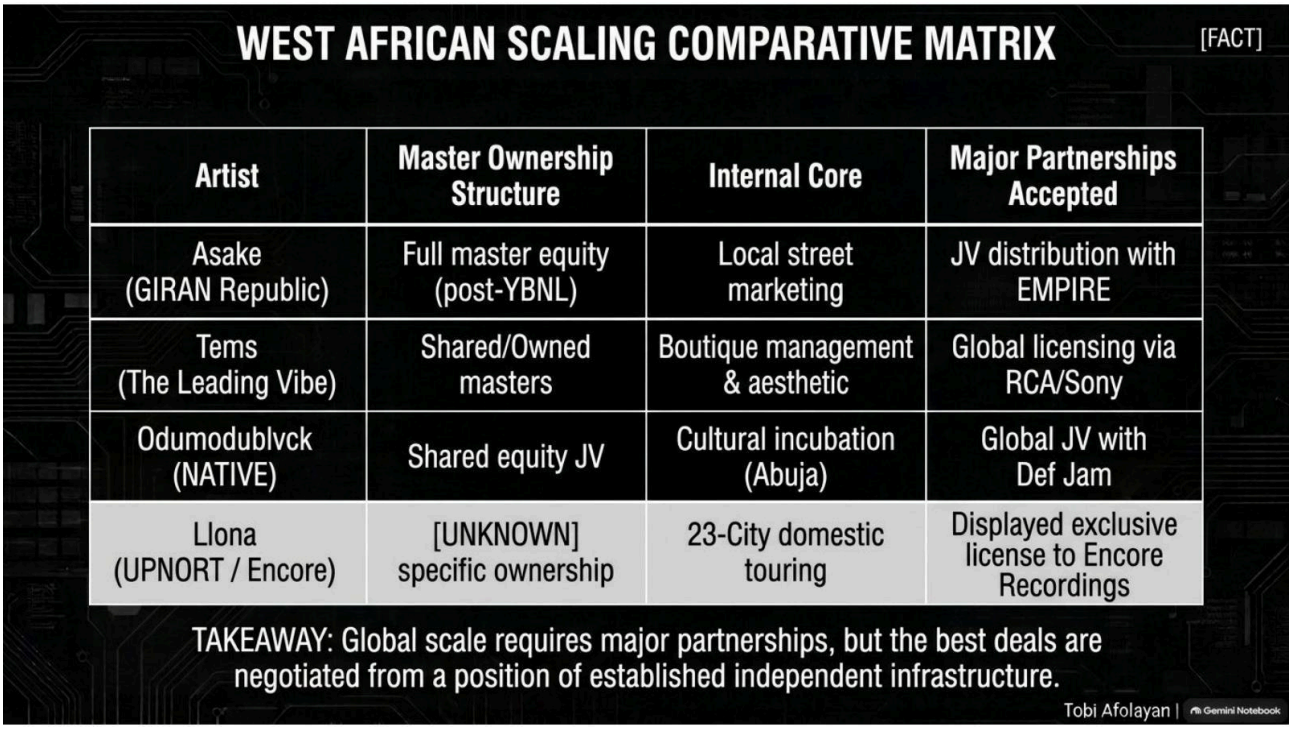
Llona strategy slide 15



Automatic transcription for reference

TRADE (THE LEVERAGE QUESTION) AuslSisa09 Rights / Economics Transformational Capability What capability is valuable enough to justify giving someone rights or control? Global Major Label JV: Exchanging 50% of profit and Frontline Licensing (e.g., Sony Music UK / AWAL): temporary exclusive licensing in exchange for multi- Exchanging a percentage of master revenue for million dollar marketing capital and global terrestrial established international crossover infrastructure and radio deployment. sync power. TAKEAWAY: State the strategic logic: Never trade equity for a service you could have simply bought. Tobi Afolayan | mcemini notebook

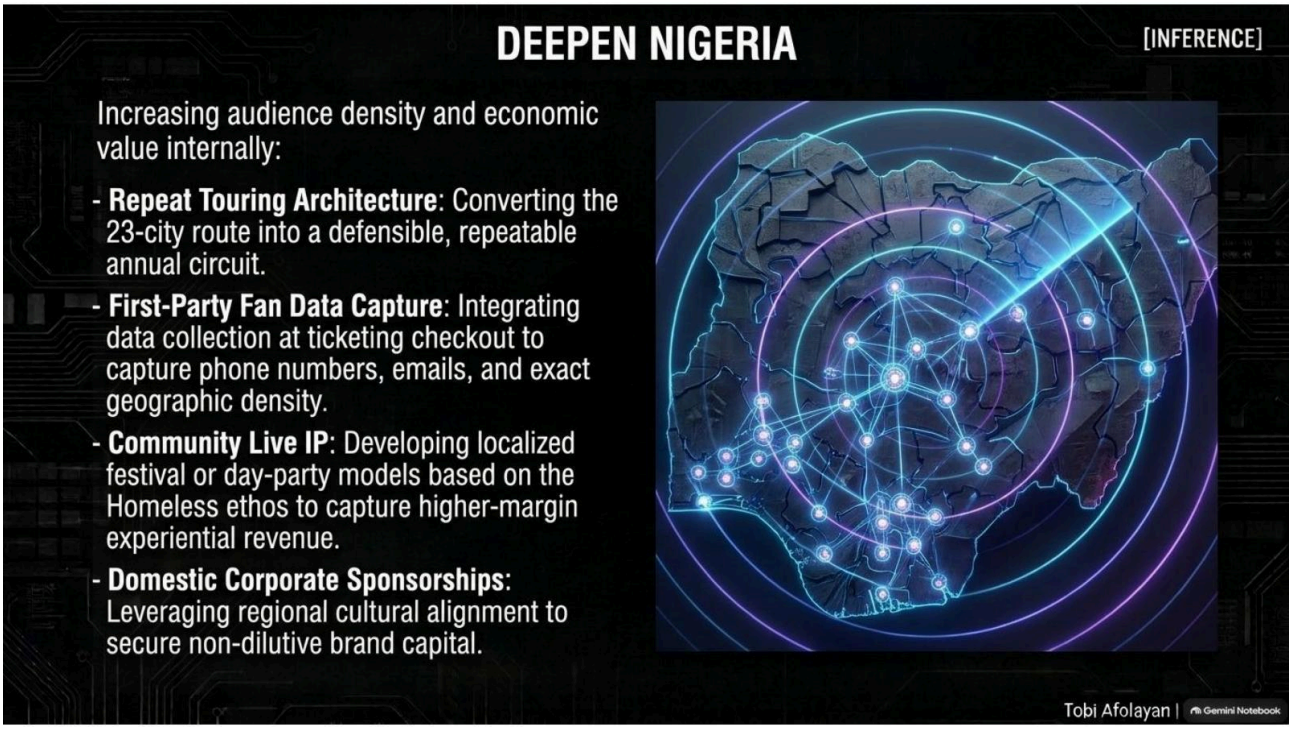
Llona strategy slide 16



Automatic transcription for reference

WEST AFRICAN SCALING COMPARATIVE MATRIX ; Master Ownership Major Partnerships Artist Stalin Internal Core Accepted Asake Full master equity Local street JV distribution with (GIRAN Republic) (post-YBNL) marketing EMPIRE Tems Shared/Owned Boutique management | Global licensing via (The Leading Vibe) masters & aesthetic RCA/Sony Odumodublvck ; Cultural incubation Global JV with (NATIVE) Shared equity JV (Abuja) Def Jam Llona (UPNORT / Encore) [UNKNOWN] specific ownership 23-City domestic touring Displayed exclusive license to Encore Recordings TAKEAWAY: Global scale requires major partnerships, but the best deals are negotiated from a position of established independent infrastructure. FACT] Tobi Afolayan | mceminotebook

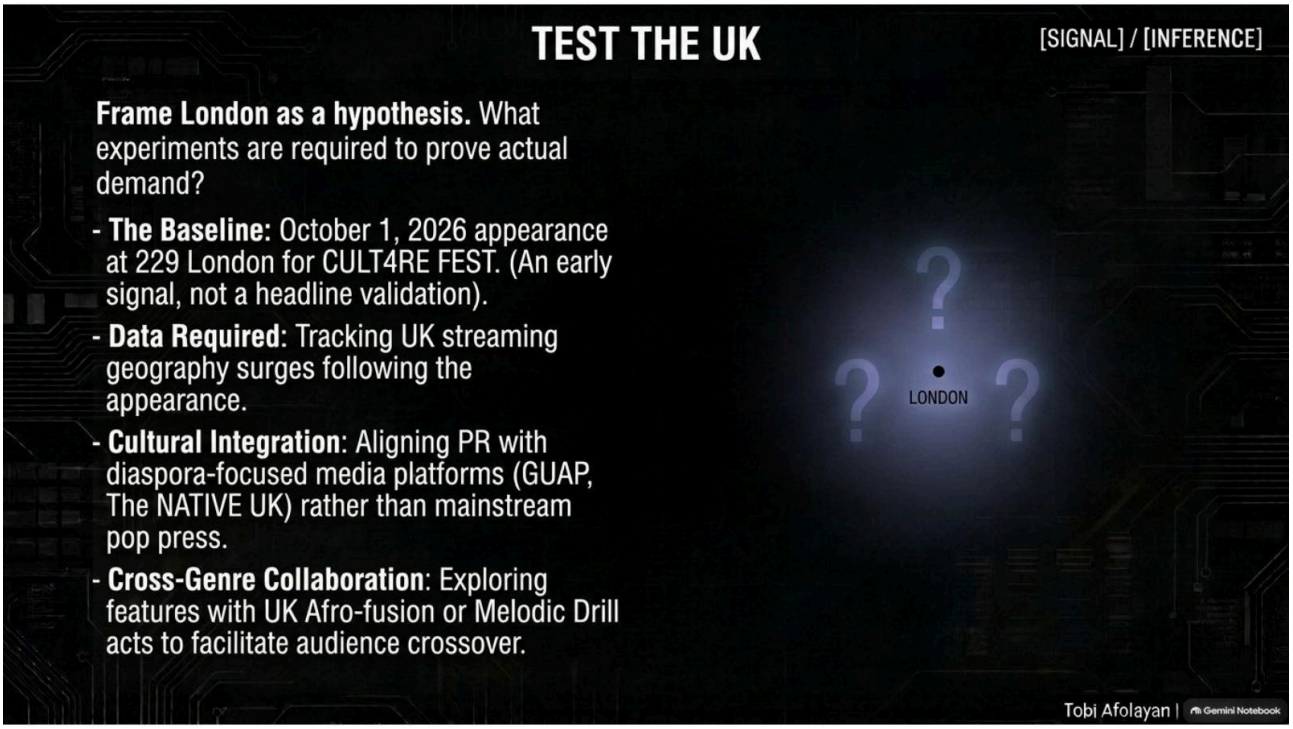
Llona strategy slide 17



Automatic transcription for reference

DEEPEN NIGERIA [INFERENCE] Increasing audience density and economic value internally: - Repeat Touring Architecture: Converting the 23-city route into a defensible, repeatable annual circuit. - First-Party Fan Data Capture: Integrating data collection at ticketing checkout to capture phone numbers, emails, and exact geographic density. - Community Live IP: Developing localized festival or day-party models based on the Homeless ethos to capture higher-margin experiential revenue. - Domestic Corporate Sponsorships: Leveraging regional cultural alignment to secure non-dilutive brand capital. Tobi Afolayan | cemininotebook

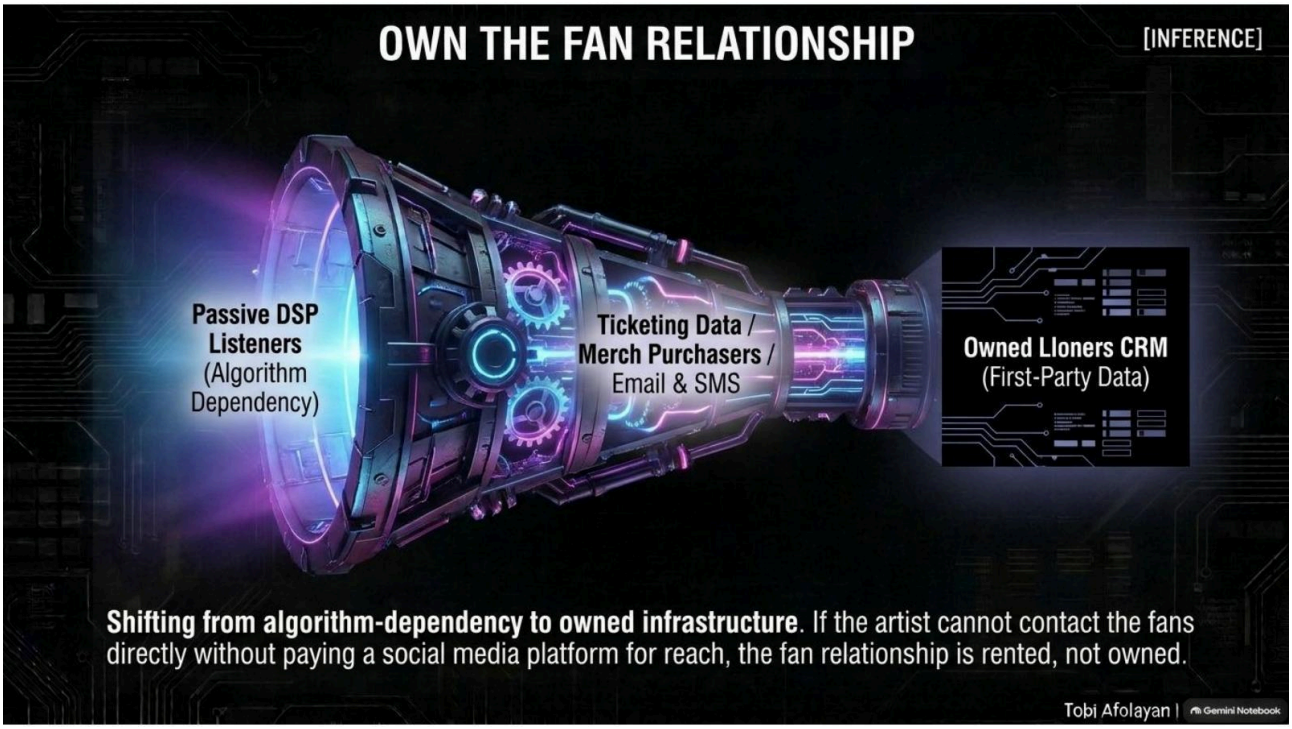
Llona strategy slide 18



Automatic transcription for reference

TEST THE UK [SIGNAL] / [INFERENCE] Frame London as a hypothesis. What experiments are required to prove actual demand? - The Baseline: October 1, 2026 appearance at 229 London for CULT4RE FEST. (An early signal, not a headline validation). - Data Required: Tracking UK streaming geography surges following the appearance. - Cultural Integration: Aligning PR with diaspora-focused media platforms (GUAP, The NATIVE UK) rather than mainstream pop press. - Cross-Genre Collaboration: Exploring features with UK Afro-fusion or Melodic Drill acts to facilitate audience crossover. Tobi Afolayan | cemininotebook

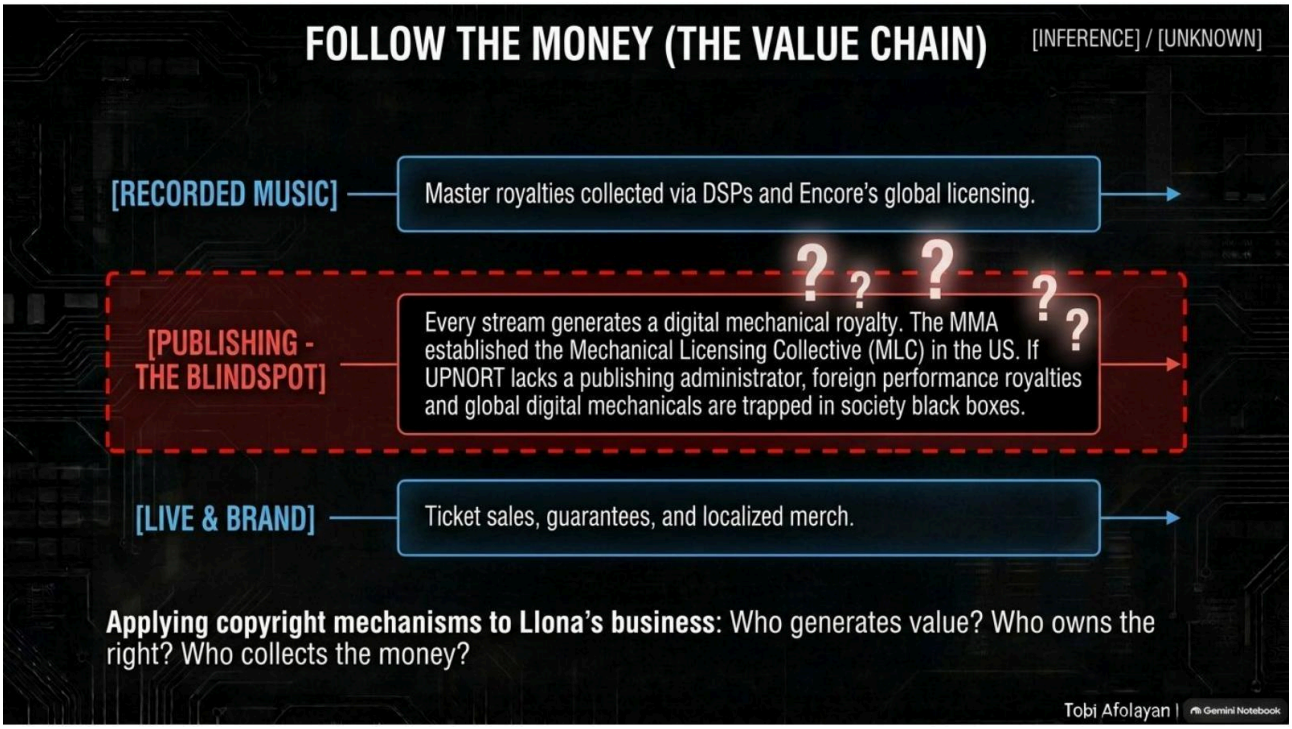
Llona strategy slide 19



Automatic transcription for reference

OWN THE FAN RELATIONSHIP [INFERENCE] Passive DSP we Ticketing Data / = ie Listeners iz Merch Purchasers / Owned Lloners CRM (Algorithm ww Email & SMS Dependency) : a 4 (First-Party Data) Shifting from algorithm-dependency to owned infrastructure. If the artist cannot contact the fans directly without paying a social media platform for reach, the fan relationship is rented, not owned. Tobi Afolayan | cemininotebook

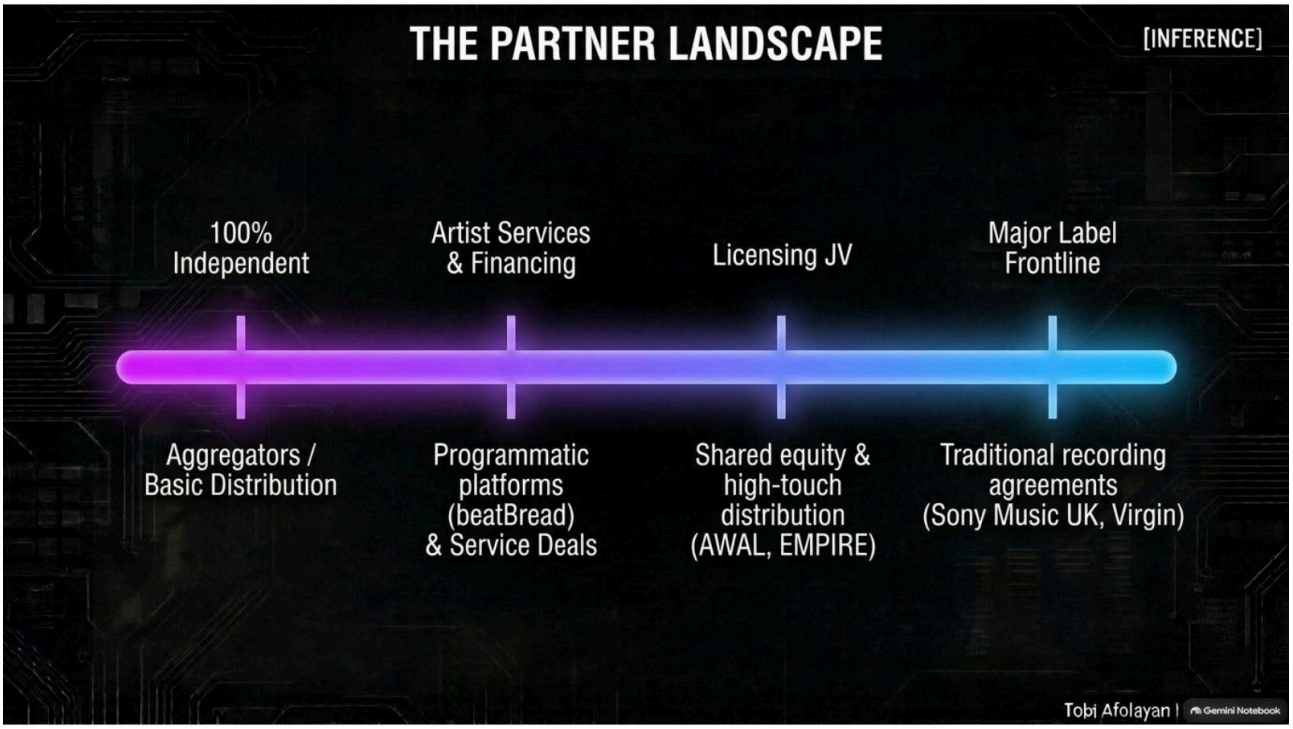
Llona strategy slide 20



Automatic transcription for reference

FOLLOW THE MONEY (THE VALUE CHAIN) FERENCE / (unknown [RECORDED MUSIC] —_ Master royalties collected via DSPs and Encore's global licensing. — as aE 2,2 Every stream generates a digital mechanical royalty. The MMA [PUBLISHING - established the Mechanical Licensing Collective (MLC) in the US. If = THE BLINDSPOT] UPNORT lacks a publishing administrator, foreign performance royalties and global digital mechanicals are trapped in society black boxes. [LIVE & BRAND] ———_ Ticket sales, guarantees, and localized merch. oe Applying copyright mechanisms to Llona's business: Who generates value? Who owns the right? Who collects the money? Tobi Afolayan | ™cemininiotebook

Llona strategy slide 21



Automatic transcription for reference

THE PARTNER LANDSCAPE [INFERENCE] 100% Artist Services eae Major Label Independent & Financing Licensing JV Frontline Aggregators / Programmatic Shared equity & Traditional recording Basic Distribution platforms high-touch agreements (beatBread) distribution (Sony Music UK, Virgin) & Service Deals (AWAL, EMPIRE) Tobi Afolayan | cemininotesook